front matter

preface

When we started our career as software developers in 2008, we didn’t care about operations. We wrote code, and someone else was responsible for deployment and operations. A huge gap existed between software development and IT operations back then. On top of that, releasing new features was risky because it was impossible to test all the changes to software and infrastructure manually. Every six months, when new features needed to be deployed, we experienced a nightmare.

Then, in 2012, we became responsible for a product: an online banking platform. Our goal was to iterate quickly and to be able to release new features for the product every week. Our software was responsible for managing money, so the quality and security of the software and infrastructure were as important as the ability to innovate. But the inflexible on-premises infrastructure and the outdated process of deploying software made those goals impossible to reach. We started to look for a better way.

Our search led us to Amazon Web Services, which offered a flexible and reliable way to build and operate our applications. The possibility of automating every part of our infrastructure struck us as fascinating and innovative. Step by step, we dove into the different AWS services, from virtual machines to distributed message queues. Being able to outsource tasks like operating an SQL database or a